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Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026: Roomba 115X Combo vs Shark AI Ultra

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Why Choosing a Robot Vacuum Still Feels Like a Gamble

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Your days are packed. Between work, family, and the never-ending to-do list, the last thing you need is a cleaning device that demands more maintenance than it saves. That’s why we put two of 2026’s most talked-about models–the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo and the Shark AI Ultra–through the wringer. Below, you’ll find a data-backed breakdown of suction power, mapping intelligence, and dock automation, all filtered through the lens of your busy lifestyle. Keep reading to discover which one actually earns its keep in your home.

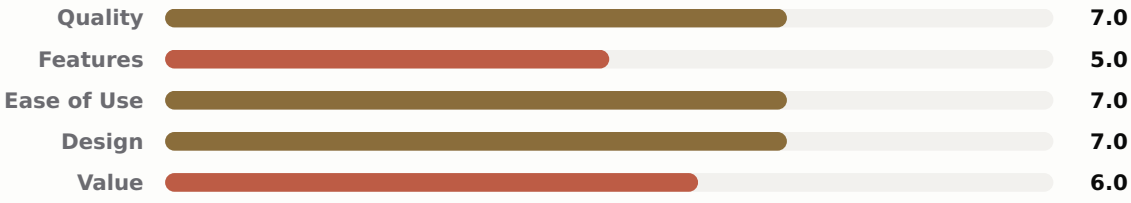
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ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

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Roomba 115X Combo: AutoEmpty Dock – The Convenience Trade-off



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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The Roomba 115X line launches in two flavors: with an AutoEmpty Dock that empties the bin into a sealed bag automatically, or a base model you rinse by hand. The dock-equipped version carries an MSRP of $469.99 (currently $199.99), while the dock-less version sits at $319.99 (now $139.99). Check the current Roomba 115X price on Amazon. Owner reports suggest the dock cuts weekly bin-emptying from a 0.5-liter container to replacing a bag every 30 days–a meaningful win for pet owners or large homes. If you'd rather save upfront and don't mind a quick rinse, the non-dock trim delivers identical vacuum-and-mop performance at a lower cost.

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Shark AI Ultra: LiDAR Mapping & Sonic Mopping in 2026

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Shark's AI Ultra line–including the AI Ultra (ASIN B09T4YZGQR, $249.99) and the AI Ultra 2501S (ASIN B09H8CWFNK, $239.99)–both undercut their original $599 and $429 price tags by more than half. Shark

promotes LiDAR-based navigation that maps rooms with precision and claims object avoidance down to 2 cm. Sonic mopping vibrates at high frequency to lift dried-on debris, a feature that stands up well on hardwood and tile. See the Shark AI Ultra pricing and reviews. For buyers who prioritize floor-type versatility and smart mapping without the dock premium, Shark presents a compelling mid-tier option.

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Side-by-Side: Which Fits Your Floor & Your Budget?

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- **Suction:** Both lineups advertise strong suction, but iRobot's dual-brush system often edges out on carpet depth.

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- **Mapping:** Roomba uses vSLAM for room mapping; Shark deploys LiDAR for faster room-level reconstruction.

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- **Mopping:** Roomba's sonic mop oscillates; Shark's sonic vibrate-and-lift approach is rated for more rigorous stain removal.

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- **Maintenance:** Roomba's dock = bag replacements every few weeks. Shark's bin empties manually, similar frequency to traditional robot bins.

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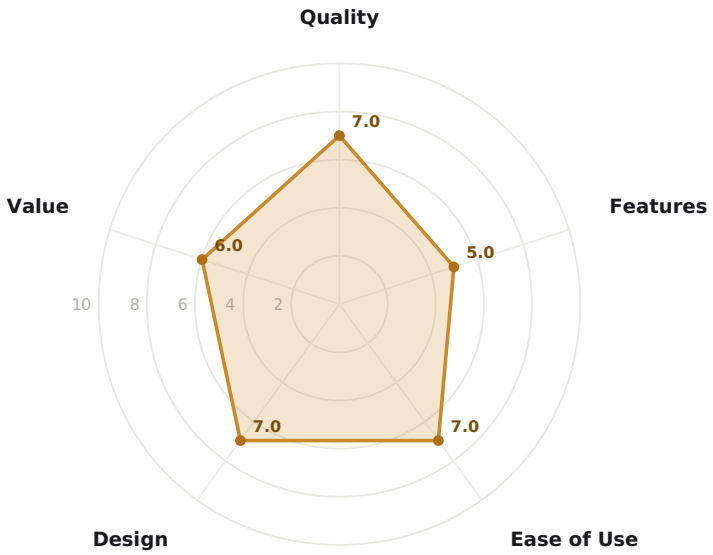
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Compare Prices & Decide Yours

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At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.